

Aligning WordNet senses with ERG lexical types

Dan Flickinger

DELPH-IN Summit 2026

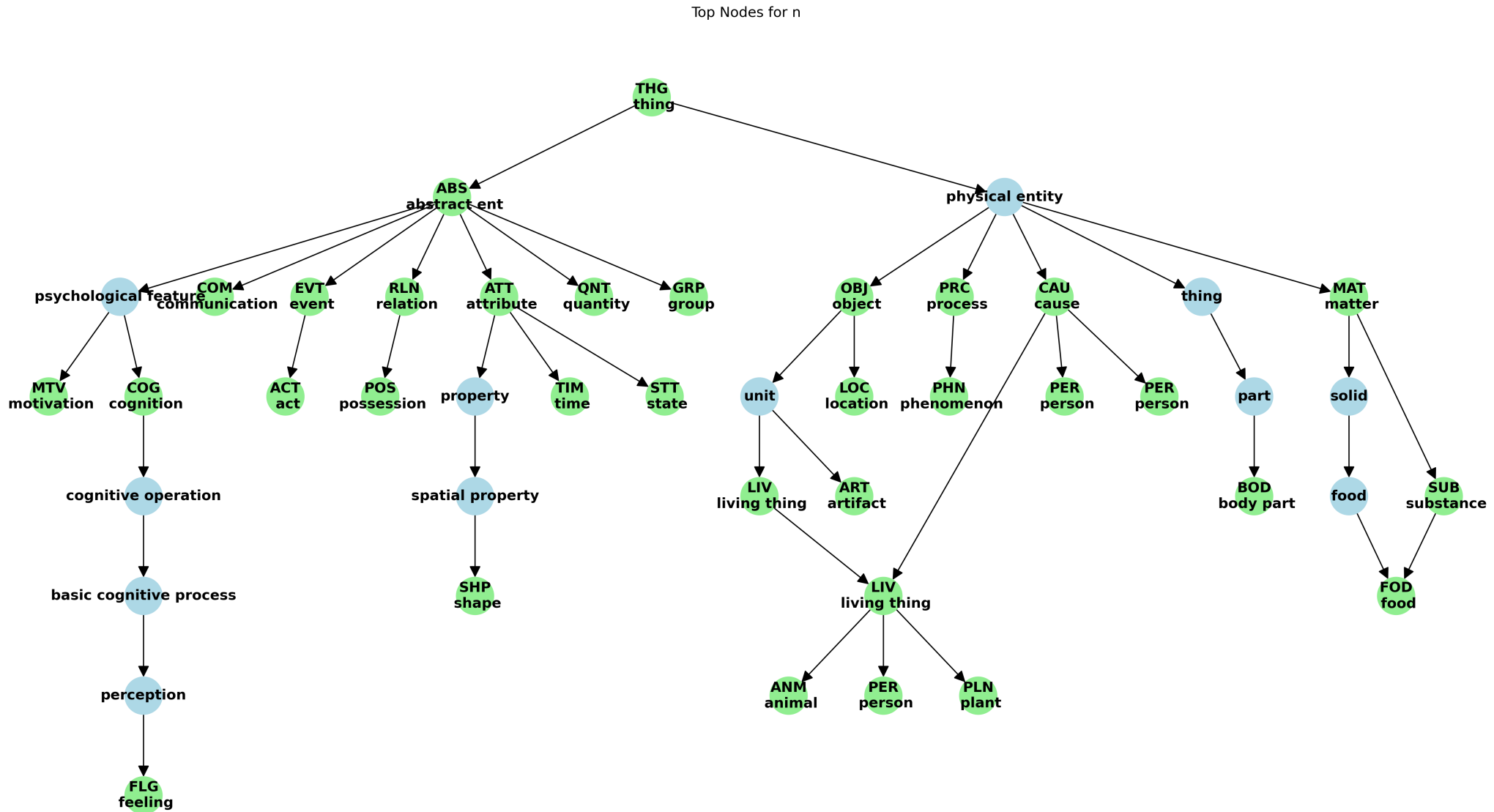
Bergen

27 July 2026

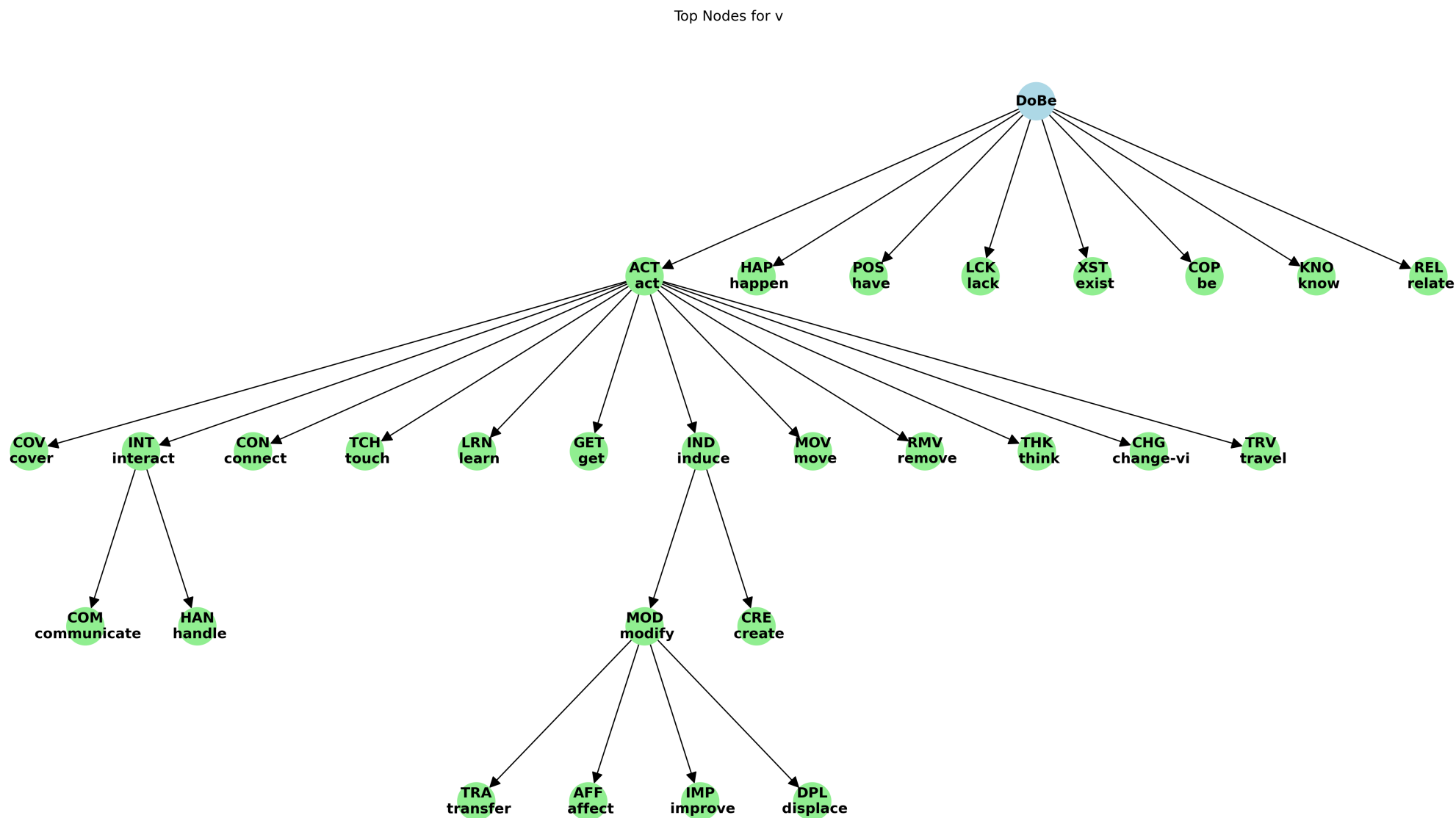
Goals

- Align ERG lexical entries with coarse WordNet synsets
- Add 100,000 lexical entries from WordNet to ERG
- Update Redwoods treebank (1.5M words) with enriched lexicon
- Propose more detailed verb valence frames for WordNet
- Propose improvements to WordNet synsets

Synset groupings for nouns



Synset groupings for verbs



Number of WN synsets per ERG lexical entry

synsets	entries
1	37936
2	9472
3	3041
4	1283
5	561
6	304
7	196
8	102
9	75
10	93
11	28
12	29
13	51
14	24
15	19
16	7
17	9
18	5
19	5
21	13
25	4
27	3
Total	53260

Causative-inchoative alternation

- 480 such verb pairs in current ERG
- *Someone broke the window* vs. *The window broke.*
window is ARG2 of transitive, ARG1 of intransitive
- In old ERG, contrast `_break_v_cause` with `_break_v_1`
- In new ERG, contrast `_break_v_act` with `_break_v_chg` (change)

Other senses of “break”

- Transitive

WN-communicate: *broke the news*

WN-create: *can you break a five?*

WN-have: *the interest costs will break me*

WN-induce: *broke a bad habit*

WN-interact: *broke a law, broke a promise*

WN-know: *they finally broke the code*

WN-think: *broke the will*

- Intransitive

WN-displace: *it's your turn to break* [in pool]

WN-happen: *this news just broke*

WN-move: *the clouds broke after the storm*

WN-travel: *the horses broke from the stable*

Verb-particle entries for “break”

- *break down* WN-change: *the car broke down*
- *break even* WN-act: *we barely broke even*
- *break in* WN-interact: *they broke in during the night*
- *break in* WN-interact: *they broke the door in*
- *break off* WN-change: *a piece broke off*
- *break off* WN-displace: *they broke off a branch*
- *break open* WN-modify: *they broke open the barrel*
- *break open* WN-change: *the barrel broke open*
- *break out* WN-remove: *they broke out the good wine*
- *break out* WN-change: *war broke out*
- *break out* WN-travel: *the prisoners broke out*
- *break up* WN-act: *the police broke up the party*
- *break up* WN-change: *the ice broke up*

Improvement in treebanking tool

- Thanks to Luis, extension to FFTB to show WordNet docstrings
- Implemented via two files added to FFTB's render.js
 - File extracting all WN docstrings from ERG lexicon
 - File mapping all inflected forms to their lexical entries
- Small Flask server delivers contents of these files on mouseover

Treebanking example “break up”

Jul 26 07:07

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s x 127.0.0.1:41745/private/sess x +

http://127.0.0.1:41745/private/session?0

He saw Mose squatting by the hearth , breaking up hardtack into a pan .

15 remaining. Gold tree is out.

/ 41011114 -- accepted
[prev](#) | [next](#) | [accept](#) | [reject](#) | [list](#) | [exit](#) | [[show](#) | [hide ignored text](#)]

1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-trv_le
breaking
break_v1-trv
1 trees

pp_-i_le
up
up_adv1
11 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-thk_le
breaking
break_v1-thk
1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-pos_le
breaking
break_v1-pos
1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-mod_le
breaking
break_v1-mod
1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-kno_le
breaking
break_v1-kno
1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-int_le
breaking
break_v1-int
1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-ind_le
breaking
break_v1-ind
1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-dpl_le
breaking
break_v1-dpl
1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-cre_le
breaking
break_v1-cre
1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-com_le
breaking
break_v1-com
1 trees

v_prp_olr
|
v_np_noger-act_le
breaking
break_v1-act
1 trees

hd-cmp_u_c
breaking up
4 trees

hd-aj_vmod_c

11 new manual

hd-cmp_u_c	+	1 to 3	[x]
hd-cmp_u_c	+	8 to 11	[x]
hdn_bnp_c @n_ms_ilr @n_-m-fod_le	=	10 to 11	[x]
n_sg_ilr @n_-c-loc_le	=	6 to 7	[x]
v_prp_olr @v_-act_le	=	3 to 4	[x]
hd-cmp_u_c	=	1 to 15	[x]
p_np_i-dgsp_le	=	4 to 5	[x]
hd-cmp_u_c	=	4 to 8	[x]
hd-cmp_u_c	=	8 to 11	[x]
hd-aj_int-unsl_c	=	3 to 8	[x]
p_np_i_le	=	11 to 12	[x]

6 gold manual [\[all on\]](#) | all off

hd-aj_scp-pr_c	+	3 to 15	[on] off
hd-cmp_u_c	+	8 to 11	[on] off
hd-cmp_u_c	+	1 to 3	[on] off
hd-cmp_u_c	+	8 to 10	[on] off
v_np-prd_oeq_le	+	1 to 2	[on] off
n_pp_c-of_le	+	13 to 14	[on] off

100 gold inferred [\[all on\]](#) | all off

After selecting head-complement for “break up”

Jul 26 07:08

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s x 127.0.0.1:41745/private/sess x +

http://127.0.0.1:41745/private/session?0

He saw Mose squatting by the hearth , breaking up hardtack into a pan .

4 remaining. Gold tree is out. / 41011114 -- accepted
[prev](#) | [next](#) | [accept](#) | [reject](#) | [list](#) | [exit](#) [[show](#) | [hide ignored text](#)]

Exact Unary Chain ▾

v_np-prtcl_dlr
|
v_prp_olr
|
v_p-np_trv_le
breaking
break_in_v1-trv
break_up_v1-trv
1 trees

v_np-prtcl_dlr
|
v_prp_olr
|
v_p-np_mod_le
breaking
break_open_v1-mod
break_up_v1-mod
break_off_v1-mod
break_down_v1-mod
break_in_v1-mod
1 trees

v_np-prtcl_dlr
|
v_prp_olr
|
v_p-np_dpl_le
breaking
break_off_v1-dpl
break_up_v1-dpl
1 trees

v_np-prtcl_dlr
|
v_prp_olr
|
v_p-np_act_le
breaking
break_in_v1-act
break_up_v1-act
1 trees

12 new manual (click here to close)
Docs: break_up_v1-
mod
[wndf] take apart into its constituent pieces [01661660-v]
[wndf] make a break in [00780320-v]
[wndf] discontinue an association or relation; go different ways [02436167-v]
[wndf] come to an end [00356457-v]
[wndf] destroy the completeness of a set of related items [01613367-v]
[wndf] bring the association of to an end or cause to break up [00356609-v]
p_np_l_e = 11 to 12 [x]
hd_cmp_u_c = 8 to 10 [x]
6 gold manual [all on | all off]
hd-aj_scp-pr_c + 3 to 15 [on | off]
hd_cmp_u_c + 8 to 11 [on | off]
hd_cmp_u_c + 1 to 3 [on | off]
hd_cmp_u_c + 8 to 10 [on | off]
v_np-prd_oeg_le + 1 to 2 [on | off]
n_nn_c-of_le + 13 to 14 [on | off]

Treebanking example intransitive “break”

Jul 26 07:14

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s x 127.0.0.1:51873/private/sess x +

http://127.0.0.1:51873/private/session?0

Earthquakes result when movements in the earth twist rocks until they break .

7 remaining. Gold tree is out. / 40521079 -- accepted
[prev](#) | [next](#) | [accept](#) | [reject](#) | [list](#) | [exit](#) [[show](#) | [hide ignored text](#)]

Exact Unary Chain ▾

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-act_le

break
break_v2-act

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-chg_le

break
break_v2-chg

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-com_le

break
break_v2-com

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-dpl_le

break
break_v2-dpl

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-hap_le

break
break_v2-hap

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-mov_le

break
break_v2-mov

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-trv_le

break
break_v2-trv

1 trees

10 new manual

n_-_pr-they_le	+	10 to 11	[x]
sb-hd_mc_c	+	0 to 2	[x]
hd-aj_scp_c	+	0 to 13	[x]
hd-cmp_u_c	=	7 to 9	[x]
v_n3s-bse_ilr @v_np_act_le	=	7 to 8	[x]
hdn_bnp_c @n_pl_olr @n_-_c_obj_le	=	8 to 9	[x]
hdn_optcmp_c @n_pl_olr @n_pp_mc-of-phn_le	=	3 to 4	[x]
hdn_bnp_c @n_pl_olr @n_-_c-phn_le	=	0 to 1	[x]
n_ms-cnt_ilr @n_-_mc-obj_le	=	6 to 7	[x]
v_n3s-bse_ilr @v_-_unacc-hap_le	=	1 to 2	[x]

5 gold manual [\[all on\]](#) | all off]

hd-cmp_u_c	-	7 to 9	[on] off]
hd-aj_scp_c	+	0 to 13	[on] off]
sb-hd_mc_c	+	0 to 2	[on] off]
n_-_mc_le	+	6 to 7	[on] off]
n_-_pr-they_le	+	10 to 11	[on] off]

Showing definition for WN-travel “break”

Jul 26 07:13

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s x 127.0.0.1:51873/private/sess x +

http://127.0.0.1:51873/private/session?0

Earthquakes result when movements in the earth twist rocks until they break .

7 remaining. Gold tree is out. / 40521079 -- accepted
[prev](#) | [next](#) | [accept](#) | [reject](#) | [list](#) | [exit](#) [[show](#) | [hide ignored text](#)]

Exact Unary Chain ▾

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-act_le

break
break_v2-act

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-chg_le

break
break_v2-chg

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-com_le

break
break_v2-com

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-dpl_le

break
break_v2-dpl

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-hap_le

break
break_v2-hap

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-mov_le

break
break_v2-mov

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-trv_le

break
break_v2-trv

1 trees

(click here to close)

10 new manual
Docs: break_v2-trv
[wndf] pierce or penetrate [01230960-v]
[wndf] make a rupture in the ranks of the enemy
or one's own by quitting or fleeing [02034609-v]
[wndf] move away or escape suddenly
[02077161-v]

5 gold manual [all on] [all off]
hd-cmp_u_c - 7 to 9 [on] [off]
hd-aj_scp_c + 0 to 13 [on] [off]
sb-hd_mc_c + 0 to 2 [on] [off]
n_-_mc_le + 6 to 7 [on] [off]
n_-_pr-they_le + 10 to 11 [on] [off]

Showing definition for WN-change “break”

Jul 26 07:13

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s x 127.0.0.1:51873/private/sess x +

http://127.0.0.1:51873/private/session?0

Earthquakes result when movements in the earth twist rocks until they break .

7 remaining. Gold tree is out. / 40521079 -- accepted
[prev](#) | [next](#) | [accept](#) | [reject](#) | [list](#) | [exit](#) [[show](#) | [hide ignored text](#)]

Exact Unary Chain ▾

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-act_le

break
break_v2-act

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-chg_le

break
break_v2-chg

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-com_le

break
break_v2-com

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-dpl_le

break
break_v2-dpl

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-hap_le

break
break_v2-hap

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-mov_le

break
break_v2-mov

1 trees

v_n3s-bse_ilr
|
v_-_unacc-trv_le

break
break_v2-trv

1 trees

(click here to close)

Docs: break_v2-chg

[wndf] curl over and fall apart in surf or foam, of waves [\[01976990-v\]](#)

[wndf] crack; of the male voice in puberty [\[00259252-v\]](#)

[wndf] fail to agree with; be in violation of; as of rules or patterns [\[02674312-v\]](#)

[wndf] be released or become known; of news [\[00938019-v\]](#)

[wndf] emerge from the surface of a body of water [\[01995361-v\]](#)

[wndf] become separated into pieces or fragments [\[00334996-v\]](#)

[wndf] become fractured; break or crack on the surface only [\[00337070-v\]](#)

[wndf] go to pieces [\[01372011-v\]](#)

[wndf] come forth or begin from a state of latency [\[02631268-v\]](#)

[wndf] be broken in [\[00203148-v\]](#)

[wndf] come into being [\[00559613-v\]](#)

[wndf] fall sharply [\[00154854-v\]](#)

[wndf] diminish or discontinue abruptly [\[00107408-v\]](#)

Transitive WN-know “break”

Jul 26 07:18

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s × 127.0.0.1:58985/private/sess × +

http://127.0.0.1:58985/private/session?2

In the unfertile land in Palestine humans broke their backs pushing will power to the brink .

11 remaining. Gold tree is out. / 41017011 -- accepted
[prev](#) | [next](#) | [accept](#) | [reject](#) | [list](#) | [exit](#) | [[show](#) | [hide ignored text](#)]

Exact Unary Chain ▾

v_pst_olr v_np_noger-trv_le broke break_v1-trv 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-thk_le broke break_v1-thk 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-pos_le broke break_v1-pos 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-mod_le broke break_v1-mod 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-kno_le broke break_v1-kno 1 trees
v_pst_olr v_np_noger-int_le broke break_v1-int 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-ind_le broke break_v1-ind 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-dpl_le broke break_v1-dpl 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-cre_le broke break_v1-cre 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-com_le broke break_v1-com 1 trees
v_pst_olr v_np_noger-act_le broke break_v1-act				

11 new manual (click here to close)
Docs: break_v1-kno
[wndf] find the solution or key to [\[00740319-v\]](#)

loc_le	@n_-pn-	=	5 to	[x]
hd-cmp_u_c	@n_pp_mc-of-loc_le	=	4	[x]
n_pl_olr	@n_-c-ed-bod_le	=	9 to 10	[x]
v_prp_olr	@v_np*_dpl_le	=	10 to 11	[x]
n_sg_olr	@n_pp_c-of-loc_le	=	15 to 16	[x]
flr-hd_nwh-nc_c		+	0 to 17	[x]
hd-cmp_u_c		+	10 to 13	[x]
hd-cmp_u_c		+	0 to 6	[x]
hd-aj_scp_c		+	7 to 17	[x]
d_-poss-their_le		=	8 to 9	[x]
hd_xaj-int-vp_c	@hd-cmp_u_c	=	7 to 10	[x]

Transitive WN-communicate “break”

Jul 26 07:19

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s × 127.0.0.1:58985/private/sess × +

http://127.0.0.1:58985/private/session?2

In the unfertile land in Palestine humans broke their backs pushing will power to the brink .

11 remaining. Gold tree is out. / 41017011 -- accepted
[prev](#) | [next](#) | [accept](#) | [reject](#) | [list](#) | [exit](#) | [[show](#) | [hide ignored text](#)]

Exact Unary Chain ▾

v_pst_olr v_np_noger-trv_le broke break_v1-trv 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-thk_le broke break_v1-thk 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-pos_le broke break_v1-pos 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-mod_le broke break_v1-mod 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-kno_le broke break_v1-kno 1 trees
v_pst_olr v_np_noger-int_le broke break_v1-int 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-ind_le broke break_v1-ind 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-dpl_le broke break_v1-dpl 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-cre_le broke break_v1-cre 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-com_le broke break_v1-com 1 trees
v_pst_olr v_np_noger-act_le broke break_v1-act				

(click here to close)

Docs: break_v1-com

[wndf] make known to the public information that was previously known only to a few people or that was meant to be kept a secret [\[00935783-v\]](#)

[wndf] force out or release suddenly and often violently something pent up [\[01789214-v\]](#)

Transitive WN-have “break”

Jul 26 07:19

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s × 127.0.0.1:58985/private/sess × +

http://127.0.0.1:58985/private/session?2

In the unfertile land in Palestine humans broke their backs pushing will power to the brink .

11 remaining. Gold tree is out. / 41017011 -- accepted
[prev](#) | [next](#) | [accept](#) | [reject](#) | [list](#) | [exit](#) | [[show](#) | [hide ignored text](#)]

Exact Unary Chain ▾

v_pst_olr v_np_noger-trv_le broke break_v1-trv 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-thk_le broke break_v1-thk 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-pos_le broke break_v1-pos 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-mod_le broke break_v1-mod 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-kno_le broke break_v1-kno 1 trees
v_pst_olr v_np_noger-int_le broke break_v1-int 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-ind_le broke break_v1-ind 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-dpl_le broke break_v1-dpl 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-cre_le broke break_v1-cre 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-com_le broke break_v1-com 1 trees
v_pst_olr v_np_noger-act_le broke break_v1-act				

11 new manual (click here to close)
Docs: break_v1-pos
[wndf] reduce to bankruptcy [02323145-v]

loc_le @n_pp_mc-of-loc_le = 5 to 6 [x]
@n_pp_mc-of-loc_le = 4 [x]
n_pl_olr @n_-c-ed-bod_le = 9 to 10 [x]
v_prp_olr @v_np*_dpl_le = 10 to 11 [x]
n_sg_flr @n_pp_c-of-loc_le = 15 to 16 [x]
flr-hd_nwh-nc_c + 0 to 17 [x]
hd-cmp_u_c + 10 to 13 [x]
hd-cmp_u_c + 0 to 6 [x]
hd-aj_scp_c + 7 to 17 [x]
d_-poss-their_le = 8 to 9 [x]
hd_xaj-int-vp_c @hd-cmp_u_c = 7 to 10 [x]

Transitive WN-modify “break”

Jul 26 07:19

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s x 127.0.0.1:58985/private/sess x +

http://127.0.0.1:58985/private/session?2

In the unfertile land in Palestine humans broke their backs pushing will power to the brink .

11 remaining. Gold tree is out. / 41017011 -- accepted
[prev](#) | [next](#) | [accept](#) | [reject](#) | [list](#) | [exit](#) | [show](#) | [hide ignored text](#)

Exact Unary Chain ▾

v_pst_olr v_np_noger-trv_le broke break_v1-trv 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-thk_le broke break_v1-thk 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-pos_le broke break_v1-pos 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-mod_le broke break_v1-mod 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-kno_le broke break_v1-kno 1 trees
v_pst_olr v_np_noger-int_le broke break_v1-int 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-ind_le broke break_v1-ind 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-dpl_le broke break_v1-dpl 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-cre_le broke break_v1-cre 1 trees	v_pst_olr v_np_noger-com_le broke break_v1-com 1 trees
v_pst_olr v_np_noger-act_le broke break_v1-act				

(click here to close)

Docs: break_v1-mod

[wndf] cease an action temporarily [00781106-v]
[wndf] destroy the completeness of a set of related items [01613367-v]
[wndf] lessen in force or effect [00390886-v]
[wndf] give up [02687334-v]
[wndf] interrupt the flow of current in [00780790-v]
[wndf] discontinue an association or relation; go different ways [02436167-v]
[wndf] render inoperable or ineffective [00259551-v]
[wndf] fracture a bone of [00107543-v]
[wndf] terminate or end [00364717-v]
[wndf] make submissive, obedient, or useful [00202933-v]
[wndf] put an end to a state or an activity [02686624-v]
[wndf] weaken or destroy in spirit or body [00030456-v]
[wndf] interrupt a continued activity [02541382-v]

Transitive “break” parse tree

Jul 26 07:33

Inbox - danflick@alumni.s x 127.0.0.1:58985/private/sess x +

http://127.0.0.1:58985/private/session?2

In the unfertile land in Palestine humans broke their backs pushing will power to the brink .

1 remaining. Gold tree is out.

/ 41017011 -- accepted
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[Show MRS]

v_prp_oir @v_np*_api_le = 11 [x]
n_sg_ilr @n_pp_c-of-loc_le = 15 to 16 [x]
flr-hd_nwh-nc_c + 0 to 17 [x]
hd-cmp_u_c + 10 to 13 [x]
hd-cmp_u_c + 0 to 6 [x]
hd-aj_scp_c + 7 to 17 [x]
d_-poss-their_le = 8 to 9 [x]
hd_xaj-int-vp_c @hd-cmp_u_c = 7 to 10 [x]
v_pst_olr @v_np_noger-mod_le = 7 to 8 [x]
7 gold manual [\[all on\]](#) | all off]
flr-hd_nwh-nc_c + 0 to 17 [\[on\]](#) | off]
v_np-pp_prop_le + 10 to 11 [\[on\]](#) | off]
hd-cmp_u_c + 10 to [\[on\]](#) |

Issues in ERG-WN alignment

- Named entities: anchor and add unanchored entry for each name
 - Paris*: cities and people
 - Garfield*: president in, comics cat not
 - Wilson*: ten individuals included
 - Saratoga*: battle in, city not
- DEI
 - Harlem*: "a district of Manhattan; now largely a Black ghetto"
 - Libyan*: "Libyan terrorists"
- Comparative adjectives: missing links
 - e.g. *healthier*: no link to *healthy*
- Productive ERG derivations: how to link WN verb synsets
 - em over-: *overcharge*, *overuse*, *oversupply*
 - em counter-: *countersign*

Proposed improvements to WordNet

- Split 100 or so verb synsets for caustive/inchoative alternation
bend, brew, defrost, melt, rotate, switch off, ...
- Reassign a dozen verb synsets from inchoative to causative
extract, lop off, postmark, unfasten, ...
- Add several inchoative verb synsets
kick up, knot, rip, tear, ...
- Add a dozen causative verb synsets
conflate, crumple, flatten out, tilt, ...
- Add 100 missing verb synsets
appraise “the house should appraised for two million”
blow away - amaze; dominate in competition
car pool “we’ll car pool tomorrow”
pencil in - to schedule
report to - be supervised by

Benefits of ERG-WN alignment beyond verbs

- Regular alternations in proper names

We ordered books from Amazon.

We found rare fish in the Amazon.

We visited Rocky.

We visited the Rockies.

- Mass/count distinctions

pitch: coated in pitch; swung at a pitch

arms: took up arms; raised an arm

gossip: spread gossip; be a gossip

sake: drink some sake; for her sake